

A. Initial funding (the "customer already gave us money" part)

- When a customer pays the retainer lump sum upfront, should the system generate a formal Invoice for that amount at the moment the retainer is created? Or is that payment handled entirely outside the system (invoiced/collected some other way), and the retainer is just an internal balance tracker?

- Yes, it should have an Invoice if they paid a Retainer amount/ but customer will use the initial funding example for there subscription/upgrades and etc. system should generate another invoice if it collected from Funding as due balance will be 0.00 and mark as paid if funding can cover all

- If yes to an invoice — should it be marked Paid immediately (since the money's already in hand), or does it need to go through the normal Send → Pay flow?

B. Drawing down the balance (the core question you raised)

- When you use retainer money to deliver a service or sell a product, should the system create a real Invoice for that specific piece of work (so there's a document showing exactly what was delivered), with its amount automatically deducted from the retainer? Or should usage stay as a simple internal log entry (amount + description, no invoice) like it works today?
- If an invoice is generated per use — should it be auto-marked Paid (covered by the retainer), or left unpaid until someone confirms the draw?
- Can a single use draw from more than one source — e.g., invoice is AED 1,000, only AED 700 left on the retainer: does the system split it (AED 700 from retainer + AED 300 as a normal payment), or is that not allowed (usage must always fit within what's left)?

C. Is this a one-time pot or a recurring subscription?

- both one time payment & subscription

- Is a Retainer always a single lump sum the customer pays once and draws down until it's gone? Or can it be a recurring thing — the customer is billed the same amount every month/quarter, and each new invoice tops the balance back up?
- If recurring — does unused balance roll over to the next period, or does it reset to zero each cycle ("use it or lose it")?
- If recurring — should that periodic invoice be generated automatically on schedule, or manually triggered (same as how Recurring Invoices work today — nothing fires by itself)?

D. Contract end / expiry

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- Does a retainer contract have an end date? If the contract period ends with money still left on it — is that balance forfeited, refunded, or rolled into a new contract?

-yes

- Should the system alert anyone (you or the customer) when a retainer is about to expire, or when the balance is running low?

-yes

E. Refunds and overdraw

-For now we will only give Transfer or Roll over new contract. Forfeit and Refunds need admin approve

- Can a customer ever get refunded unused retainer balance (e.g., they cancel early)? If yes, does that need to produce a real accounting record (similar to how we now generate a negative-value invoice for standalone credit notes)?
- Should overdrawing ever be allowed with manual approval, or should it always be a hard cap like it is now (can't log usage bigger than what's remaining)?

F. Visibility

-yes

- Should retainer activity (funding, draws, balance changes) show up in the Customer Statement report alongside their invoices and payments, so you get one full financial picture per customer?